

GRADE 10 ENGLISH

LEARNER'S RESOURCE PAMPHLET

*Your quick-reference guide to Listening & Speaking, Reading,
Grammar in Use, and Writing*

Based on the KICD Senior School Curriculum Design
For learners aged 14–16

Explored through 9 real-life themes:

Etiquette • Environment • Technology • Travel • Careers • Culture • Sports & Games • Health & Safety • Income

How To Use This Pamphlet

This pamphlet is organised into the four strands you'll meet in Grade 10 English. Each topic gives you:

- A short, simple explanation of the skill.
- Key things you should be able to do.
- 💡 DID YOU KNOW? boxes with fun facts.
- ✎ TRY THIS activities you can do on your own or with a friend.
- ★ QUICK TIP boxes with exam and everyday-life tips.
- 🔑 KEY WORDS you need to know.

Use it alongside your class notes, textbook, and teacher's guidance — this pamphlet is a quick companion, not a replacement for full lessons.

Contents

- STRAND 1 — Listening and Speaking (10 topics)
- STRAND 2 — Reading (5 topics)
- STRAND 3 — Grammar in Use (5 topics)
- STRAND 4 — Writing (7 topics)

STRAND 1

LISTENING AND SPEAKING

Every conversation, class discussion, phone call, and speech you'll ever give depends on two skills: listening well and speaking clearly. This strand helps you sharpen both — from picking up small details in a story to speaking confidently in a meeting.

1.1 Extensive Listening

Extensive listening means listening to longer stories, recordings, dialogues or dramatisations just to enjoy them and get the general picture — not to catch every single word.

What you should be able to do

- Describe characters, places, and memorable events from a recording.
- Pick out key/general details from a recording.
- Retell a story or dialogue for enjoyment.



TRY THIS

Listen to a Kenyan radio drama or podcast episode. Afterwards, tell a friend the story in your own words — who was involved, where it happened, and what stood out to you.

1.2 Etiquette in Communication

Etiquette is about using polite, appropriate language and behaviour when speaking and listening — at home, in class, on the phone, and online.

- Use polite greetings and forms of address suited to the situation (formal vs informal).
- Wait for your turn to speak; don't interrupt.
- Use appropriate telephone and email etiquette (greeting, introducing yourself, closing politely).
- Adjust your tone and word choice depending on who you're addressing (a teacher vs a friend).



QUICK TIP

Before a phone call to someone you don't know well, plan your opening line: greeting + who you are + why you're calling.

1.3 Critical Listening

Critical listening means listening beneath the surface — judging whether what is said is fact or opinion, true or exaggerated, logical or biased.

- Distinguish between facts and opinions in a spoken text.
- Identify the speaker's purpose, attitude, and possible bias.
- Evaluate the strength of an argument you hear.



KEY WORDS

Fact: a statement that can be proven true.

Opinion: a personal belief or judgement.

Bias: a leaning towards one side unfairly.

1.4 Pronunciation and Conversational Skills

Clear pronunciation and natural conversation skills help people understand you the first time — no repeating yourself!

- Practise correct stress on syllables (e.g. PHOto vs phoTOGrapher).
- Use emphatic stress to highlight the most important word in a sentence.
- Use natural conversational openers, fillers, and closers ('That reminds me...', 'Anyway...', 'It was great talking to you.').
- Practise conducting and participating in simple meetings — stating a point, agreeing, disagreeing politely.



TRY THIS

Record yourself reading a short paragraph aloud. Listen back — did you stress the right syllables? Try again, exaggerating the stressed syllable until it feels natural.

1.5 Intensive Listening & Viewing

Intensive listening is close, detailed listening — used when you need to catch specific facts, figures, or instructions, such as in a video lesson or news bulletin.

- Listen/view for precise facts, figures, and named details.
- Take short, accurate notes while listening.
- Confirm understanding by summarising what was said.

1.6 Non-verbal Cues

Communication isn't only about words — body language, facial expressions, gestures, eye contact and tone of voice all carry meaning.

- Identify what different gestures, facial expressions and postures communicate.
- Match tone of voice to the intended message (sarcasm, sincerity, urgency).
- Use appropriate eye contact and posture when speaking to an audience.



DID YOU KNOW?

Studies suggest a large share of everyday meaning is carried through tone of voice and body language, not just the words used — which is why the same sentence can sound friendly or rude depending on how it's said.

1.7 Selective Listening

Selective listening means tuning in for only the specific information you need — like listening for a bus departure time in a long announcement.

- Identify strategies for selecting specific information from a listening text (e.g. listening for key words, numbers, names).
- Filter out irrelevant details.
- Follow spoken instructions and directions accurately.

1.8 Interactive Listening & Conducting Meetings

Interactive listening happens in two-way exchanges — discussions, interviews, and meetings — where you must listen and respond in real time.

- Respond appropriately to questions and comments during a discussion.
- Use polite phrases to agree, disagree, or ask for clarification.
- Follow the basic structure of a meeting: opening, agenda items, discussion, closing.

QUICK TIP

Useful meeting phrases: "Could you clarify that point?", "I'd like to add something here," "I see it differently because..."

1.9 Responsive Listening

Responsive listening is about giving appropriate verbal and non-verbal feedback to show you are engaged — nodding, saying 'I see', asking follow-up questions.

- Give appropriate verbal feedback (short responses, follow-up questions).
- Use non-verbal feedback (nodding, eye contact, facial expression) to show attention.

1.10 Speaking Fluency

Fluency means speaking smoothly, at a natural pace, with clear organisation — without long, awkward pauses or excessive fillers.

- Organise your spoken ideas logically (introduction, main point, examples, conclusion).
- Speak at an appropriate pace — not too fast to be understood, not so slow it loses the listener.
- Use linking expressions to move between ideas ('Firstly...', 'On the other hand...', 'In conclusion...').

TRY THIS

Give a 1-minute talk on your favourite hobby to a partner without using 'um' or 'ah'. If you slip, pause silently instead — it sounds more confident!

STRAND 2

READING

Reading well is more than moving your eyes across a page — it's about reading at the right speed for the right purpose, and getting real meaning out of what you read.

2.1 Reading Fluency

Fluent reading means reading smoothly, accurately, and at a good pace, with proper expression — so that you understand as you go, instead of struggling word-by-word.

- Read aloud with correct pronunciation, phrasing and expression.
- Adjust your reading speed depending on the difficulty of the text.
- Read silently at a pace that supports comprehension.

QUICK TIP

Practise reading a news article aloud for one minute daily. Time yourself and track how your smoothness improves over a week.

2.2 Extensive Reading

Extensive reading is reading widely and for pleasure — novels, magazines, articles — to build vocabulary, general knowledge and a love for reading, without stopping to analyse every detail.

- Read whole texts (short stories, articles, novels) for enjoyment and general understanding.
- Build vocabulary naturally through wide reading.
- Discuss and share opinions about what you've read.

TRY THIS

Choose a novel, newspaper feature, or online article on a topic you enjoy (sports, technology, celebrities) and read it purely for pleasure this week — no notes required!

2.3 Study Skills

Study skills are reading strategies that help you extract information efficiently from textbooks and reference material for schoolwork and research.

- Use tables of contents, indexes, headings, and glossaries to locate information quickly.
- Skim a text to get the general idea; scan a text to find specific facts.
- Take organised notes (e.g. using headings, bullet points, or mind maps).
- Reference sources correctly when researching.

KEY WORDS

Skimming: quickly reading to get the main idea.

Scanning: quickly searching for a specific fact or word.

Reference: acknowledging where information came from.

2.4 Intensive Reading

Intensive reading is close, careful reading of a shorter passage to fully understand its meaning, structure, and the writer's intention — the kind of reading used for comprehension exercises.

- Identify the main idea and supporting details in a passage.
- Work out the meaning of unfamiliar words from context.
- Answer comprehension questions accurately, using evidence from the text.

2.5 Critical Reading

Critical reading goes further than understanding — it means questioning, evaluating, and forming your own judgement about a text: is the writer being fair? What is their purpose? Do you agree?

- Identify the writer's purpose, tone and point of view.
- Distinguish between fact and opinion in a written text.
- Evaluate the writer's arguments and evidence.
- Form and justify your own opinion about the text.



DID YOU KNOW?

Critical readers ask questions as they read: 'Why did the writer choose this word?', 'What is left out?', 'Whose side is this written from?' Try asking yourself these next time you read a newspaper opinion piece.

STRAND 3

GRAMMAR IN USE

Grammar is the toolkit that lets you build clear, correct sentences. This strand covers word classes, phrases, clauses, and sentence structure — the building blocks of everything you say and write.

3.1 Word Classes: Verbs

Verbs are the 'action' or 'state' words in a sentence. Grade 10 focuses on main verbs, primary auxiliary verbs, and how verbs change to show tense and aspect.

- Main verbs express the core action or state, e.g. run, think, is.
- Primary auxiliary verbs — be, have, do — help form tenses and questions, e.g. 'She is running', 'They have finished', 'Do you agree?'
- Regular verbs form the past tense by adding -ed (walk → walked).
- Irregular verbs change form unpredictably (go → went, eat → ate).
- Phrasal verbs combine a verb with a preposition/adverb for a new meaning (give up, look after, break down).



KEY WORDS

Tense: when the action happens (past, present, future).

Aspect: whether the action is complete, ongoing, or habitual.

3.2 Word Classes: Adverbs

Adverbs add detail to verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs — telling us how, where, or when something happens.

- Adverbs of manner: how something is done (quickly, carefully).
- Adverbs of place: where something happens (here, outside).
- Adverbs of time: when something happens (yesterday, soon).
- Gradable adverbs can be intensified (very quickly); non-gradable ones usually cannot (completely, uniquely).



TRY THIS

Write three sentences about your weekend, each using a different type of adverb (manner, place, time).

3.3 Phrases

A phrase is a group of related words that acts as a single unit in a sentence, but does not contain both a subject and a verb (unlike a clause).

- Noun phrase: a group of words built around a noun, e.g. 'the tall boy at the gate.'
- Verb phrase: a main verb plus its auxiliaries/modifiers, e.g. 'has been working hard.'
- Prepositional phrase: begins with a preposition, e.g. 'under the bridge', 'since morning.'
- Adjectival and adverbial phrases modify nouns or verbs, adding extra description.

3.4 Clauses

A clause contains both a subject and a verb. Sentences are built from one or more clauses.

- Independent (main) clause: can stand alone as a complete sentence, e.g. 'The rain stopped.'
- Dependent (subordinate) clause: cannot stand alone; it depends on a main clause, e.g. 'because the rain stopped...'
- Relative clauses give extra information about a noun, e.g. 'the man who called yesterday.'
- Joining clauses correctly with conjunctions (and, but, because, although) avoids fragments and run-on sentences.

QUICK TIP

A common exam trap is the comma splice — joining two independent clauses with only a comma ('I was tired, I went to bed'). Fix it with a full stop, semicolon, or a conjunction: 'I was tired, so I went to bed.'

3.5 Sentence Structure

Sentences can be built in different ways to add variety and precision to your writing and speech.

- Simple sentence: one independent clause, e.g. 'The dog barked.'
- Compound sentence: two independent clauses joined by a conjunction, e.g. 'The dog barked, and the cat ran.'
- Complex sentence: an independent clause plus a dependent clause, e.g. 'When the dog barked, the cat ran.'
- Active sentence: the subject performs the action, e.g. 'The teacher marked the exams.'
- Passive sentence: the subject receives the action, e.g. 'The exams were marked by the teacher.'
- Subject-verb agreement: a singular subject takes a singular verb; a plural subject takes a plural verb, e.g. 'She writes' / 'They write.'

TRY THIS

Take the sentence 'The chef cooked the meal.' Rewrite it in the passive voice, then combine it with another idea to make a complex sentence.

STRAND 4

WRITING

Good writing is a skill you build step by step: smooth sentences, correct spelling and punctuation, logical organisation, and knowing the right format for the right purpose.

4.1 Sentence Fluency

Sentence fluency means writing sentences that flow naturally and read smoothly, avoiding awkward repetition or choppy, disconnected ideas.

- Vary sentence length and structure to keep writing interesting.
- Avoid comma splices and run-on sentences.
- Use transition words to connect ideas smoothly (however, therefore, meanwhile).

4.2 Mechanics of Writing: Spelling

Correct spelling helps your reader understand you instantly, without being distracted by errors.

- Learn frequently misspelt and easily confused words (e.g. their/there/they're, affect/effect, its/it's).
- Understand common abbreviations and acronyms (e.g. etc., NGO, KCSE) and when to use them.
- Apply basic spelling rules (e.g. 'i before e except after c').

QUICK TIP

Keep a personal 'tricky words' list in your notebook. Add any word you misspell in an exercise, and review it before tests.

4.3 Mechanics of Writing: Punctuation

Punctuation marks guide your reader — showing where ideas start, stop, pause, or connect.

- Full stop (.) ends a complete sentence.
- Comma (,) separates items in a list, or clauses, or adds a pause.
- Apostrophe (') shows possession (Maria's book) or a contraction (don't).
- Colon (:) introduces a list or explanation; semicolon (;) links two related independent clauses.
- Quotation marks (" ") show direct speech or a quoted phrase.

4.4 Elements of Effective Writing

Effective writing isn't just correct — it's clear and well organised, so ideas flow logically from one to the next.

- Cohesion: using connecting words to link ideas (addition: also, furthermore; similarity: likewise, similarly; contrast: however, on the other hand).
- Paragraph development: start with a topic sentence, follow with supporting details, and end with a concluding or linking idea.
- Order ideas logically — chronologically, by importance, or by cause and effect.

TRY THIS

Write a short paragraph about a memorable school event. Use at least one connector of addition and one of

contrast.

4.5 The Writing Process

Good writers rarely get it right in one draft. Following a process helps you produce clear, polished final work.

- Prewriting: brainstorm and plan your ideas before you start writing.
- Drafting: write a first version, focusing on getting ideas down.
- Revision: reread and improve content, organisation, and clarity.
- Editing: correct grammar, spelling, and punctuation errors.
- Publishing: produce a clean final copy to share or submit.

★ QUICK TIP

Never skip revision! Read your draft aloud — awkward or unclear sentences usually 'sound wrong' when spoken.

4.6 Creative Writing

Creative writing lets you use language artistically to describe, narrate, and bring people, places, and events to life.

- Descriptive essay: paints a vivid picture of a person, place, or thing using sensory details (sight, sound, smell, touch, taste) and figurative language (similes, metaphors).
- Narrative essay: tells a story with a clear beginning, middle, and end, built around a central event or conflict.
- Verb derivations: turning other word classes into vivid verbs for a stronger effect (e.g. 'simplify', 'organise' from adjectives/nouns).

💡 DID YOU KNOW?

A simile compares two things using 'like' or 'as' ('brave as a lion'), while a metaphor states one thing IS another ('he is a lion in battle') — metaphors are often more powerful because they're more direct.

4.7 Functional Writing

Functional writing serves a specific, practical purpose in real life — school, work, or the community — and follows set formats.

- Letters of complaint, request, and inquiry: state your purpose clearly, use a polite and formal tone, and follow the standard letter layout (sender's address, date, recipient, salutation, body, closing).
- Simple reports, memos, and emails: use clear headings, state facts objectively, and keep language concise and professional.
- Notice of a meeting, agenda, and minutes: a notice states what, when, and where a meeting will be; an agenda lists items to discuss; minutes record what was discussed and decided.

✎ TRY THIS

Draft a short email to a school club patron requesting permission to hold a fundraising event. Include a clear subject line, a polite opening, your request, and a courteous closing.

🔑 KEY WORDS

Salutation: the greeting in a letter/email (Dear Sir/Madam,).

Agenda: a list of items to be discussed at a meeting.

Minutes: an official written record of what happened in a meeting.